ONE-PAGE PREACHING OUTLINE

The Man Who Never Asked

The Man Born Blind · John 9:1–41

Primary text: John 9:1–41 **Also read:** John 10:1–18 · Genesis 2:7 · 2 Kings 20:20 · Isaiah 8:6 · Nehemiah 3:15 **Big idea:** The light comes to the man who never asked, and goes looking for him after the room casts him out. **Time:** 55–60 minutes, including a 3–5 minute response (6,559 words at about 125 wpm). **Aim:** Move the room from asking "Who sinned?" to saying "One thing I know," and from staying inside the room to going after the one it threw out.

MOVEMENT MAP

MIN	SECTION	BEATS AND TRANSITION
5	**Introduction: The question in the street**	The disciples ask whose fault the blindness is while the man listens. He is a case file with a heartbeat. Jesus refuses the equation: "the works of God might be displayed in him." The light of the world stands beside a man who never asks. → *"The light walked over to the darkness and crouched down beside it."*
7	**The man nobody asked**	The theology of retribution, and the Bible's own complication of it (Job 42:7; Luke 13:1–5). Jesus sees a man, not a problem. The night is coming. Grace arrives before the ask. → *"The disciples saw a theological problem. Jesus saw a man."*
8	**Mud and the Sent Pool**	Spit and dust; Genesis 2:7; the Creator uses dirt. "Go, wash in Siloam" — the name means Sent. The man walks in the dark by trust. He washes and sees. The pool is real: Hezekiah's tunnel, the Siloam inscription, the 2004 discovery. → *"He went. He washed. He came back seeing."*
6	**The neighbors and the first testimony**	The neighbors cannot agree who he is; "I am the man." His first testimony is simple: "the man called Jesus." His Christology grows from a name to a prophet to a man from God to Lord. → *"He knew one thing, and he held on to it, and the light kept growing."*
8	**The interrogations**	The Sabbath charge; the Pharisees divide. The parents go silent for fear of expulsion. "Give glory to God." "One thing I know." The logic of the healed man. "You were born in utter sin" — and they cast him out. → *"He loses his community for telling the truth about his own eyes."*
8	**Cast out and found**	Jesus hears, seeks, finds. The first face the man sees is the face of the one who healed him. "Lord, I believe" — worship in the street. The warning: those who say "We see" remain blind. → *"They threw him out. Jesus went looking."*
7	**Application: What do you do with the light?**	Stop writing the case file. Say what you know. Go looking for the cast-out. Worship before you see the whole picture. → *"The light is not a theory. It is a person."*
3	**The invitation**	Two people: the one outside who was cast out, and the one inside who thought he could see. The light is still walking. → *"Come while it is day."*
5	**Response and closing**	Silence. Name the label. Say "One thing I know." Ask, "Jesus, let me see you." Pray. → *"The light of the world walked toward a man who never asked."*

Total: 57 minutes with a full response; 55–60 with normal variation.

LINES TO LAND

- **The question:** "He is not a person in that sentence. He is a condition. A case study. A theological problem with a heartbeat."
- **The grace:** "The light walked over to the darkness and crouched down beside it."
- **The cost:** "He loses his community for telling the truth about his own eyes."
- **The turn:** "They threw him out. Jesus went looking."
- **The gospel:** "The man who was thrown out of the house of God worships the Son of God in the street."

GUARDRAILS

- Do not turn John 9:3 into a formula that says every instance of suffering is "for God's glory." Jesus says it about this man, in this story.
- Keep the archaeology in its place: the pool is real; the miracle remains a claim the text asks you to trust.
- Track the man's growing Christology. Do not make him a instant theologian; he is a witness who is still learning.
- Do not cartoon the Pharisees. John says the group was divided, and the parents' fear was real. The warning at the end is for the church too.
- Protect the casting out, the finding, the worship, the invitation, and the silence.

IF YOU MUST CUT

- **To 50 minutes:** Introduction to 4, Movement 1 to 5, Movement 2 to 6, Movement 4 to 7, Application to 6. Keep the pool, "One thing I know," and the finding.
- **Never cut:** the man never asking, the mud and the Sent pool, "One thing I know," the casting out and finding, and the worship in the street.